

because of high temperatures. You have not mentioned what power supply came with your system. We recommend a good power supply of at least 500 W for your configuration. Your mouse may be the culprit as well—mice with low DPI might give you the impression of stuttering.

Some Questions!

Q I have some questions and I would be highly obliged, if I could get the answers.

1. My current configuration is Pentium dual core 3.0 GHz with 2 GB DDR2 RAM and GeForce 8600GT 256 MB. Transcend RAM, supported by a 965 motherboard. Is this configuration sufficient to run games like *DIRT*?
2. Would a Core 2 duo processor (the basic versions) outperform a dual core clocked at 3.0 GHz?
3. How much help would it be for gaming if I upgrade from 2 GB to 4 GB of RAM?
4. Instead of RAM if I go for a 8800GT card, would it be a much better option (my budget is limited)?
5. Would you recommend me upgrading XP to Vista for gaming?

Raunaq Sahay

A Your system configuration should be able to run the game *Dirt* at medium settings at resolutions of 1024x768 just fine. A Core 2 Duo and a GeForce 9600GT or one of the newly released cards—Radeon 4850 priced at around \$200 from ATI should do much more. A Core 2 Duo running at 3 GHz can help further improve the performance. The Core 2 Duo E8400 is one such processor that runs at 3.0 GHz. 2 GB of memory is decent amount of memory to run Vista and games. 4 GB of memory is just useful in making your system a little more future-proof. 4 GB of memory means you would also need to get a 64-bit OS to utilise the entire 4 GB. An 8800 GT is great value for money. With the release of new cards from NVIDIA and ATI, it is a good idea to wait a week or two till prices of the costlier 9800GTX or higher performing cards, drop to around that of 8800GT. An XP to Vista shift will not change your performance at all, so it is all up to you which OS you prefer to use.